

c. 1948

The following is a faithful transcription of typed notes by the
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TO RECOGNIZE THE CREATOR
THE FIRST PURPOSE OF THE RATIONAL CREATURE.

To know is to appreciate - is to love what is good - is to reject
what is of evil - is to adore the Divine.

What consolation this offers us! What a hopeful outlook it ought
to afford! What a sublime horizon for poor sinners, -- if "hope
is the very soul of happiness here" and if the revealed purpose
of our creation, TO KNOW GOD is kept in mind -- what a horizon
for us, even though we be sinners -- if we but keep in mind the
primary purpose of our creation, TO KNOW GOD.
Hence the lines:

God made me to know Him. O what a bless'd aim!
To love Him and serve Him sure rests in the same.
Its "Heaven Begun" for the grateful on earth;--
To treasure aright? ! Highest Heaven its worth.

But how can I know what the senses fail to perceive? How know the
Incomprehensible God whose attributes - wisdom and power and goodness
and mercy-are infinite? A simple question may, in the first place,
demand a simple answer. But right here, we shall do well to remem-
ber a trite proverb: "A fool can ask questions - can make ob-
jections - that will puzzle a philosopher to answer." A nave of
course, can ask such questions too. But perhaps the nave is sup-
posed to be included in the proverb; because after all, inasmuch
as anyone is a nave in at least so much does he prove himself in
the end to have been a fool too. While it would be uncharitable,
therefore, to say that every fool is a nave' it is always logical;
to say that every nave is a fool.

However, a simple answer to the above objection intimating
the difficulty or impossibility of a finite creature knowing the
infinite God, might be to ask another very simple question; viz.
Do the senses perceive the electricity - "the juice" in a live
wire? Or again: Do men gaze into the sun to consider its bene-
fits? Objections like the above are fatal and vain and if meant
to excuse atheism, are criminal. For there is absolutely no ex-
cuse for any rational creature refusing to recognize its Creator.
In fact, if "Gratitude for favors is one of the very first and
surest indications of intelligence", and again if according to
all logical reasoning, one's first possible benefit is his crea-
tion; then the ingratitude of the atheist, must of its very nat-
ure - without further proof or parley - condemn him with his